

Linalool



What is it?

Linalool is a substance that smells like lavender. It is a naturally-occurring fragrance found in lavender, jasmine, rosewood, basil, and thyme. It can also be made synthetically. The skin will react to both natural and synthetic sources. Linalool is used in perfumes, soaps, and cleansing products.

Linalool converts to a hydroperoxide form at room temperature, which is even more allergenic.

Fragrances give an aroma to a product. They are often mixtures which create a unique scent. Products with the terms *natural*, *unscented*, *hypoallergenic*, and *fragrance free* are not regulated and thus may contain fragrance. Do not trust these labels. However, know that true *fragrance-free* products do exist.

LINALOOL can also be known as:

Hydroperoxides of linalool

Some Possible Uses of LINALOOL / Where it might be found:

- Essential oils
- Liquid and bar soap, cleansers
- Cream, lotion, oil
- Make-up, make-up remover, toner
- Shaving cream, gel, hair removal cream, after shave
- Perfume, cologne, body mist
- Deodorant, antiperspirant
- Anti-aging cream
- Sunscreen, sunless tanner
- Powders (i.e. body, talcum, baby, foot)
- Shampoo, conditioner, mousse, hair spray
- Massage oil

- Aromatherapy
- Surgical scrubs
- Wound care products
- Medicated cream, spray
- Chinese or cassia oil
- Toothpaste, mouthwash, dental items
- Breath spray, mist, mint, candy, gum
- Sanitary napkins, light pads
- Hygiene spray, rinse
- Baby wipes, moist wipes
- Facial tissue, toilet paper
- Dish or laundry detergent
- Fabric softener, dryer sheet
- Air freshener, potpourri
- Household cleaner, anti odor
- Candles, plug-ins, incense
- Cooking and baking flavoring
- Wax, polish
- Metalworking fluid, cutting oil, anti corrosives
- Paint, paint thinner, turpentine
- Anti-insect products
- Beverages (i.e. cola, bitters, vermouth)
- Some medications (i.e. inhalants)
- Air vent systems (casinos, hotels)
- Cleaning products

Other products that might react like LINALOOL:

- Other fragrances
- Propolis
- Colophony
- Hydroperoxides of linalool

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What should I do to avoid LINALOOL?

It is best to avoid all fragrance. Even if marketed as *unscented* or *fragrance-free*, these products can contain fragrance. Look for fragrance, plant, or botanical names on labels. For products at home with no ingredients, go to the store to inspect the original package or look at the manufacturer's or store's website.

You may have to avoid airborne fragrance. For example, candles and incense. Exposure may also occur from contact with partners that use fragrance.

To identify workplace exposure, check ingredient lists. Sometimes fragrance is present even though not listed. You may need to contact the manufacturer. Material Safety Data Sheets (MSDS) sheets usually do not include the full ingredient list. Substitute fragrance-free alternatives or wear rubber or vinyl gloves.

In addition, the ACDS Contact Allergen Management Program® (CAMP®) can help manage contact dermatitis. It helps to find products that are safe to use by creating a list of products that do not contain one's allergens. For more information about CAMP®, please ask your doctor or visit www.contactderm.org.

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